



pistol SH1 event and won gold.

Their impressive performances are expected to bolster the 10-member team's prospects.

Krishna Nagar will be the sole gold medallist among India's 13-member para-badminton contingent at the Paris Paralympics. The 4'5" Nagar won gold by outlasting Hong Kong's Chu Man Kai with a thrilling 21-17, 16-21, 21-17 victory in the men's singles final of the SH6 class.

Cynosure of attention: Sheetal Devi, India's first armless archer, will make her Paralympic debut, competing in the women's compound open and mixed team compound open events. AFP

Nagar's triumph marked India's second Paralympic gold in para-badminton, following Bhagat's win in Tokyo. Manoj Sarkar and Suhas Yathiraj also won medals at the Tokyo Games, with Sarkar claiming bronze in the men's singles SL3 and Yathiraj taking silver in the men's singles SL4.

In Paris, Yathiraj, the World No. 1 in men's singles SL4, and Sarkar, ranked fourth in men's singles SL3, will compete in the same events as in Tokyo. Additionally, Yathiraj will compete in the mixed doubles SL3-SU5 event.

Sumit Antil, the only Indian para-athlete to win gold in athletics at the Tokyo Games, shattered his world record in the men's javelin throw (F64) with a remarkable distance of 68.55m.

Since then, he has continued to excel, setting the current world record with a 73.29m throw at the Hangzhou Asian Para Games in October 2023. Antil will lead a 38-member track and field team for the Paris Paralympics.

Two-time Paralympic medallist Mariyappan Thangavelu will want to replicate his gold medal-winning performance from the Rio Games in the men's high jump T-42 event, where he cleared 1.89m.

In Tokyo, he finished second behind Sam Grewe in the men's high jump T-63. His teammate, Sharad Kumar, earned bronze in the same event.

In 2024, Thangavelu reclaimed his form by breaking the championship record with a jump of 1.88m in the men's high jump T-63 final at the World Para Athletics Championships, securing gold.

The Indian para table tennis campaign is led by two women: Bhavinaben Patel and Sonalben Patel. Bhavinaben, 37, won silver in the women's singles Class 4 at the Tokyo Paralympics and followed up with gold at the 2022

Commonwealth Games and bronze at the 2022 Asian Para Games. Partnering with her in the women's doubles WD 10 event is Sonalben, who also earned a CWG bronze in the women's singles — Classes 3-5.

In addition to these disciplines, India will compete in eight other sports at the Paris Paralympics: para canoeing, para-cycling, blind judo, para powerlifting, para-rowing, para-swimming, para taekwondo, and para archery.

All eyes will be on 17-year-old Sheetal Devi as she makes her Paralympic debut, competing in the women's compound open and mixed team compound open events.

The armless archer, part of the six-member archery squad for the Games, has already made a name for herself with a silver medal at the 2023 World Para Archery Championships and two golds and a silver at the 2022 Asian Para Games. Rising to World No. 1 in women's para compound archery in the open category, she was named World Archery's 'Best Women's Para Archer of 2023'.

In 2024, Sheetal added a silver medal at the Khelo India NTPC National Ranking archery meet and secured gold in the women's compound team event with Sarita at the Para Archery Ranking Series in Czechia.

The Indian contingent will showcase a mix of seasoned champions and promising newcomers, each striving to make a significant impact.

With the Paralympic Games just around the corner, all eyes will be on these athletes as they seek to achieve new milestones and etch their names into Paralympic history.